Midterm Presentation Script V2

Slide 01

Today, I'll present my midterm project, The Language of Scent.

It's an interactive website designed to help people understand how different scent terms are classified and connected.

My original idea was to create a visual fragrance discovery service where people could explore their preferences and find similar perfumes.

But while researching existing services, I noticed that searching for perfumes was not really the main problem I wanted to solve. I was more interested in how difficult it can be to understand the descriptions themselves.

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For example, Floral and Rose both relate to flowers, but they mean different things. Floral is a fragrance family, while Rose is a specific note. And words like Sweet, Creamy, or Powdery describe the qualities of a scent.

These different types of information often appear together, so it's not always clear how they're different or related.

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That's why I decided to focus on making fragrance information easier to understand before moving into perfume recommendations.

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One of the hardest parts was figuring out how to organize the information.

Different fragrance systems use different categories and terms, and many scent descriptions overlap.

After looking at different classification systems, I chose The eight fragrance families as a starting point.

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I also separated the information into three main types: Family, Note, and Descriptor, to make their different meanings clearer.

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But these types are still connected. For example, Vanilla is one note, but it can appear in Gourmand, Ambrée, and Floriental fragrances.

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So I wanted to keep the information connected, instead of repeating it under each family.

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For the visual design, I originally wanted a clean but experimental beauty editorial style, with transparent textures, soft colors, and glass-like elements.

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I chose a neutral color palette to keep the information readable and let the different fragrance colors stand out.

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The website focuses on two main parts: Learn and the Fragrance Map.

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Users first learn the basic concepts, then explore fragrance families and their related notes and descriptors. They can also compare similar scent descriptions to understand their differences.

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Open the Published Website

[Open the website → Go to Learn]

This is the Learn section. It introduces the difference between Family, Note, and Descriptor.

I also added a few familiar examples.

[Move to Fragrance Map]

This is the main exploration area.

Here, users can select one of eight fragrance families.

[Select Floral]

When I select a family, it shows related notes and descriptors.

[Point to the shape markers]

I used different shapes to distinguish the three types: filled circles for Families, diamonds for Notes, and outlined circles for Descriptors.

[Select Musk]

When I select a specific note, I can see more details about the note, along with its related descriptors and families.

This helps users understand both the differences between these information types and how they are connected.

[Select Soapy]

For scent descriptions that are easy to confuse, like Soapy and Powdery, users can open a side by side comparison.

[Click Compare Powdery & Soapy]

These are both common fragrance descriptions, but it can be hard to imagine how they actually smell different.

I wanted to make these differences easier to understand with simple descriptions and visuals.

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For mobile, I planned a simpler layout where the map and details are stacked vertically instead of side by side.

I also wanted to make the buttons easier to use on smaller screens.

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One of my biggest challenges was balancing the information structure with the visual design.

I originally wanted more experimental visuals and animations, but I spent more time organizing the content and making the interactions clear.

So the final design is simpler than I imagined.